Kettlewick Coffee Co. Employee Handbook

Version 4.2, effective 1 March 2026. Kettlewick Coffee Co. is a fictional company used for demonstration.

1. Welcome

Kettlewick roasts specialty coffee in small batches and sells it through our online store, three cafes and a wholesale programme for restaurants. This handbook explains how we work, what you can expect from us and what we expect from you. If anything here is unclear, ask your manager or email the People team at people@kettlewick.example.

2. Working hours and remote work

Our core hours are 10:00 to 15:00 local time, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours you can arrange your day as you like, as long as you work your contracted hours (usually 40 per week).

Office and roastery staff may work remotely up to three days per week. Cafe and roastery production roles are on-site by nature; their schedules are published two weeks in advance. Fully remote arrangements need written approval from your department head.

3. Home office stipend

Employees who work remotely at least one day per week receive a one-time home office stipend of **$600** in their first 90 days, plus **$150 per year** after that for upkeep. Equipment bought with the stipend is yours to keep.

4. Paid time off

Full-time employees receive **15 days** of paid vacation per year during their first three years. From the start of year four, this rises to **20 days** per year. Part-time employees receive vacation in proportion to their contracted hours.

Vacation accrues monthly. You can carry over up to **5 unused days** into the next calendar year; any additional unused days expire on 31 March. Request vacation in the HR portal at least two weeks ahead for anything longer than three days.

In addition, everyone gets **8 paid sick days** per year. Sick days do not carry over. For absences longer than three consecutive days, we ask for a doctor's note.

Kettlewick observes 10 public holidays per year. Cafe staff who work on a public holiday are paid 1.5 times their normal rate and receive a replacement day off.

5. Parental leave

Primary caregivers receive **16 weeks** of fully paid parental leave. Secondary caregivers receive **6 weeks** of fully paid leave. Leave can be taken any time within 12 months of a birth or adoption, and can be split into up to two blocks. You become eligible after six months of employment.

6. Expenses and travel

Kettlewick reimburses reasonable business expenses. Submit receipts through the finance portal within **30 days** of the purchase; claims older than 60 days cannot be reimbursed.

- Meals while travelling: up to **$45 per day**, including tips.
- Hotels: up to $180 per night in most cities, $260 per night in New York, London and Tokyo.
- Flights: economy class for trips under 6 hours; premium economy is allowed for longer flights.
- Any single expense over **$500** needs your manager's approval before you spend it.
- Alcohol is not reimbursed, except at approved client events.

Reimbursements are paid with the next payroll run after approval, usually within two weeks.

7. Learning budget

Each employee has a learning budget of $1,000 per year for courses, books, conferences and certifications related to their role, such as barista or Q Grader certification. Unused budget does not roll over.

8. Your first week

• Day 1: laptop and accounts setup, a welcome coffee tasting with the founders.

• Day 2: safety training at the roastery (required for all staff, including remote roles).

• Days 3 to 4: shadow a teammate and meet your onboarding buddy.

• Day 5: 30-day goals agreed with your manager.

Every new hire has a 90-day probation period. You and your manager will hold check-ins at 30, 60 and 90 days.

9. Code of conduct

Treat colleagues, customers and suppliers with respect. Harassment and discrimination of any kind are not tolerated. Report concerns to your manager, the People team, or anonymously through the ethics line. Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith is itself a serious violation.

10. Staff discount

Employees get 40% off coffee and equipment in our online store and cafes, and one free bag of coffee (up to 340 g) per week.